

Cheryl's frittata with macadamia nuts, feta cheese, and shiitake mushrooms

My wife, Cheryl, was the inspiration for this frittata. My favorite part of the dish is the toasted macadamia nuts. Use high-quality, **tangy** feta for this dish, perhaps French or Israeli.

½ cup raw macadamia nuts [50g]

1 medium onion, thinly sliced

3½ tablespoons olive oil

3 garlic cloves, minced

¼ pound shiitake mushrooms, stemmed,
caps thinly sliced [125g]

2 cups packed shredded kale [500ml]

8 free-range eggs

2 fresh ripe plum tomatoes, seeded and
diced

4 ounces crumbled feta cheese (about 1 cup)
[125g]

½ teaspoon salt

Freshly ground pepper

Tabasco sauce (optional)

1. In a dry 10- to 12-inch [26- to 30-cm] cast-iron skillet set over medium heat, **toast** the macadamia nuts, shaking and moving the pan continuously, until they start to brown lightly, about 5 minutes. Let cool, then crush into smaller pieces, making sure to keep any crumbs as well.
2. In the same pan, **cook** the onion in 1½ tablespoons of the olive oil over medium heat until very soft and lightly browned, 5 to 7 minutes. Add the garlic and mushrooms; raise the heat to medium-high and cook, tossing often, until the mushrooms are tender and lightly browned, about 7 minutes. Add the kale and cook for 1 to 2 minutes, until the leaves are soft and have cooked down considerably. Transfer the ingredients to a bowl and let cool to room temperature.

3. **Break** the eggs into a bowl and whisk until well blended. Add the tomatoes, feta cheese, salt, and a generous grinding of pepper. Mix well.
4. Preheat the broiler with the oven rack set 5 to 6 inches [13 to 15cm] from the heat. Add the cooled vegetables and mushrooms to the eggs and **mix** lightly.
5. In the same skillet, **heat** the remaining 2 tablespoons olive oil over medium heat. Add the egg mixture and evenly distribute the ingredients in the pan with a fork. Lift the edges several times with a spatula and tilt the pan to let uncooked egg run underneath. Reduce the heat to medium-low and cook for 8 to 10 minutes, or until the frittata is set around the edges but still a little wobbly in the center.
6. Quickly sprinkle the macadamia nuts on top of the eggs and transfer the pan to the broiler. **Broil** about 2 minutes, or until the frittata is lightly browned and firm on top.
7. Let the finished dish rest and cool for 5 to 10 minutes before serving. **Remove** the frittata with a spatula, carefully dislodging the egg from around the inside of pan first. The frittata should slip right out onto a large plate. If it does not, slice it into quarters first. Pass a bottle of Tabasco sauce on the side, if you like.

SERVES 4 TO 6

